

AICloudStrategist

FinOps QuickStart – Engagement Proposal

Prepared for: {{CLIENT_NAME}} **Prepared by:** Anushka B, Founder – AICloudStrategist **Date:** {{PROPOSAL_DATE}} **Valid until:** {{PROPOSAL_DATE + 14 days}} **Proposal reference:** AICS-QS-{{YY}}{{MM}}-{{###}}

Summary

{{CLIENT_NAME}} is evaluating a structured FinOps engagement to establish a verified baseline of cloud spend, identify ranked savings opportunities, and equip the internal team with the tools to sustain cost discipline after our engagement ends.

This proposal covers a **two-week FinOps QuickStart** engagement against your {{AWS / Azure / GCP / multi-cloud}} environment with an approximate monthly spend of **{{SPEND_LAKH}}** lakh. The outcome is a ranked savings backlog with verified INR figures, a tagging and cost-allocation baseline, a 90-day implementation plan with named owners, and an open-source tooling foundation you keep.

Commercial terms: Fixed fee of **{{FEE_IN_INR}}** (GST extra), payable 50% at kickoff and 50% on delivery. No hourly billing, no scope-creep surcharges, no vendor licensing passed through.

Optional gain-share layer: If the engagement transitions to an Implementation Sprint or Managed Retainer, a gain-share clause aligned to verified savings can be added – see Section 7.

1. Engagement Context

Based on our discovery call on {{DISCOVERY_DATE}}, the following context frames this engagement:

- **Current monthly cloud spend:** Approximately **{{SPEND_LAKH}}** lakh across **{{CLOUDS}}**.
- **Growth trajectory:** **{{SPEND_GROWTH}}** year-over-year.
- **Primary trigger:** {{TRIGGER – e.g., “CFO questioned Q4 bill growth,” “board wants a cloud cost line-item owner,” “recent surprise spike of X lakh in month Y”}}.
- **Current FinOps posture:** {{POSTURE – e.g., “no dedicated ownership,” “tagging coverage below 50%,” “RI/SP coverage unknown”}}.
- **Expected internal stakeholders:** **{{NAMES/ROLES}}**.

This QuickStart is scoped as a **diagnostic sprint, not a transformation programme**. The objective is speed to insight: a ranked backlog in your inbox within 14 days, actionable by your own team or convertible to a follow-on engagement.

2. Scope of Work

In scope

1. **Spend baseline across all in-scope accounts** – six months of cost history pulled from AWS Cost & Usage Report / Azure Cost Management / GCP Billing Export, with anomaly and trend analysis.
2. **Commitment coverage audit** – Reserved Instances, Savings Plans, Committed Use Discounts: current coverage rate, expiry profile, and recommended portfolio action.
3. **Waste and idle resource audit** – unattached EBS/managed-disk volumes, idle load balancers, orphaned snapshots, low-utilization compute, non-lifecycle-managed object storage.
4. **Tagging and allocation review** – coverage heatmap by service/region/account, recommended taxonomy, enforcement mechanism.
5. **Architecture cost patterns** – data transfer and egress charges, NAT Gateway patterns, cross-region/cross-AZ patterns, database right-sizing.
6. **Ranked savings backlog** – every identified opportunity quantified in INR, classified by

implementation effort (≤ 1 day / 1-5 days / architectural), risk-rated, and sequenced.

7. **90-day implementation plan** – named engineering and finance owners for each action, target completion dates, measurement approach.
8. **Open-source tooling foundation** – Infracost (pre-deployment cost estimation), OpenCost (Kubernetes cost allocation, if applicable), a FOCUS-aligned cost export configuration you own.
9. **Final readout** – 90-minute working session with your engineering lead, finance contact, and any executive stakeholder invited. Not a slide deck – a decision meeting.

Out of scope

- Implementation of the recommended actions (covered under a follow-on Implementation Sprint if desired)
- Migration work, re-architecture, or workload refactoring
- Vendor negotiations with AWS/Azure/GCP sales representatives (we'll brief you; we won't be a party)
- Cloud security posture review (separate service – see aicloudstrategist.com/services.html)
- 24/7 operational monitoring or incident response

Assumptions

- Read-only IAM role / service principal / service account provided by Day 1 of Week 1
- Engineering lead available for the Day 1 kickoff (90 min) and Day 10 readout (90 min), plus ~2 hours async through the sprint
- Finance contact available for one 45-minute session in Week 1 to confirm chargeback structure (if applicable)
- Access to Terraform/Pulumi repositories for pre-deployment cost analysis (optional but recommended)

3. Delivery Timeline

Week	Days	Activity	Deliverable
Week 1 – Discover	Day 1	Kickoff, access setup, environment walk-through	Kickoff notes, data-access confirmation
	Days 2-3	Cost baseline pull, commitment coverage analysis	Baseline cost model (6-month trend)
	Day 4	Waste and idle audit	Waste inventory with INR/month
	Day 5	Tagging and allocation review	Tagging heatmap, taxonomy draft
Week 2 – Quantify	Day 6	Architecture cost patterns (egress, NAT, DB)	Architecture findings memo
	Day 7	Savings backlog ranking and quantification	Ranked backlog (draft)
	Day 8	90-day implementation plan drafting	Implementation plan (draft)
	Day 9	Client review session, refine backlog and plan	Final backlog + plan
	Day 10	Final readout, handover of open-source tooling	Final package: backlog + plan + tooling

Kickoff date: {{KICKOFF_DATE}} (14 days from signed SOW, to accommodate access setup) **Delivery date:** {{DELIVERY_DATE}} (14 calendar days after kickoff)

4. Deliverables

- 1. **Ranked Savings Backlog** (spreadsheet + PDF executive summary) Every opportunity with: savings estimate in per month, implementation effort, risk rating, dependency on other actions, recommended owner.
- 2. **Tagging & Cost Allocation Baseline** (spreadsheet + recommended taxonomy) Current coverage heatmap, recommended tag structure aligned to your cost-centre and product taxonomy, enforcement mechanism recommendation.
- 3. **90-Day Implementation Plan** (PDF) Sequenced action plan with named engineering and finance owners, target dates, measurement approach, dependencies called out.
- 4. **Open-Source Tooling Foundation** (repository handover) Configured Infracost pipeline (if applicable), OpenCost deployment manifests (if Kubernetes is in scope), FOCUS-aligned billing export setup, CI/CD integration recommendations.
- 5. **Final Readout Session** (90 minutes, recorded) Presented to your engineering lead, finance contact, and any executive stakeholder. Includes recording, slide deck, and Q&A captured as an addendum.

5. Pricing

Line item	Amount (INR)
FinOps QuickStart – fixed engagement fee	{{FEE_IN_INR}}
GST @ 18%	{{GST_AMOUNT}}
Total	{{TOTAL_AMOUNT}}

Payment milestones: - 50% at signed SOW ({{50_PERCENT}} + GST) - 50% on delivery of the final readout ({{50_PERCENT}} + GST)

Payment terms: Net 7 from invoice date. Wire transfer or UPI preferred; cheque accepted.

What this fee does NOT include: - Cloud provider costs (AWS/Azure/GCP charges remain your responsibility) - Third-party tool licences (our open-source approach means none required; if you prefer a commercial FinOps platform we can scope that separately) - Travel or on-site presence (engagement is fully remote; on-site available on request at cost)

What happens if we go over scope or time: - Scope change requests are logged and reviewed at the Day 9 client review - If additional effort is agreed, it’s priced at a separate fixed fee with your written approval – never billed hourly, never surprise - If we’re slow on our side, the delivery date moves but the fee does not

6. What You Get That You Don’t Get Elsewhere

Standard consultancy pattern	AICloudStrategist pattern
Junior analyst runs a dashboard export	Founder-led delivery with senior-architect review
Report delivered in PDF, tooling kept by consultant	Open-source tooling handover, you own it forever
Hourly billing, scope creep = bill creep	Fixed fee, fixed scope, surprise-free
Recommendations tied to their partner tools	Vendor-neutral; we don’t resell AWS/Azure/GCP credits
Gain-share conversation avoided	Gain-share layer available and structured transparently

Work subcontracted to offshore delivery	Delivered by the founder who signed the SOW
Reports written for internal consumption	Deliverables written for board-ready review

Founder-led. Enterprise-reviewed. That's the tagline because it's the operating model.

7. Optional Gain-Share Addendum

If this engagement converts to a follow-on Implementation Sprint or Managed FinOps Retainer, we offer a gain-share structure that aligns our incentives with verified savings:

- **Savings floor:** Defined as `{{FLOOR_INR}}`/month of verified cost reduction vs. the baseline established in this QuickStart
- **Gain-share percentage:** 20% of verified monthly savings above the floor
- **Measurement window:** 12 months from the date savings are realised
- **Cap:** Gain-share payments capped at 2× the fixed engagement fee of the follow-on engagement
- **Verification:** Measured against the FOCUS-aligned billing export baseline, reviewed monthly, signed off by both parties

If verified savings do not exceed the floor, no gain-share is due – only the fixed fee applies to the follow-on engagement.

This structure is optional. The QuickStart fee above stands alone regardless of whether a follow-on engagement is contracted.

8. Working Agreement

Communication cadence: - Daily async update in a shared Slack or WhatsApp channel (whichever your team prefers) - Two scheduled calls: kickoff (Day 1, 90 min) and readout (Day 10, 90 min) - Optional mid-sprint check-in on Day 5 if requested

Data handling: - Read-only access only; no write operations without explicit written approval - No data leaves your environment without your explicit written sign-off - Analysis artifacts (spreadsheets, cost exports, screenshots) delivered to you at engagement close; our copies deleted 30 days post-delivery - NDA available on request; we're happy to sign yours or provide ours

Confidentiality: - Case studies published on aicloudstrategist.com/proof.html anonymise client identity by default - With your written approval, named case studies available at no additional cost (helps you too if you want the credit)

Escalation path: - Day-to-day: Anushka B (founder, direct delivery) - Technical escalation: senior-architect oversight layer reviews every major finding - Commercial escalation: any payment or scope questions come to Anushka directly

9. Acceptance

This proposal is valid for 14 calendar days from the date above. To accept:

1. **Sign and return this proposal** via email to support@aicloudstrategist.com
2. **Provide the read-only IAM/service-principal credentials** via your preferred secure channel (we accept AWS Cross-Account roles, Azure service principals, GCP service accounts, or 1Password-style secure share)
3. **Confirm kickoff date** from the available slots: `{{SLOT_1}}`, `{{SLOT_2}}`, `{{SLOT_3}}`

On receipt, we'll send a signed counterpart, the first invoice (50%), and a kickoff calendar invite with the pre-read checklist.

Signed on behalf of AICloudStrategist:

Anushka B Founder AICloudStrategist · Rohini, Delhi 110085 · India support@aicloudstrategist.com GSTIN: {{GSTIN}}

Date: _____

Accepted on behalf of {{CLIENT_NAME}}:

Name: _____ Title: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____
